

Elemental building blocks

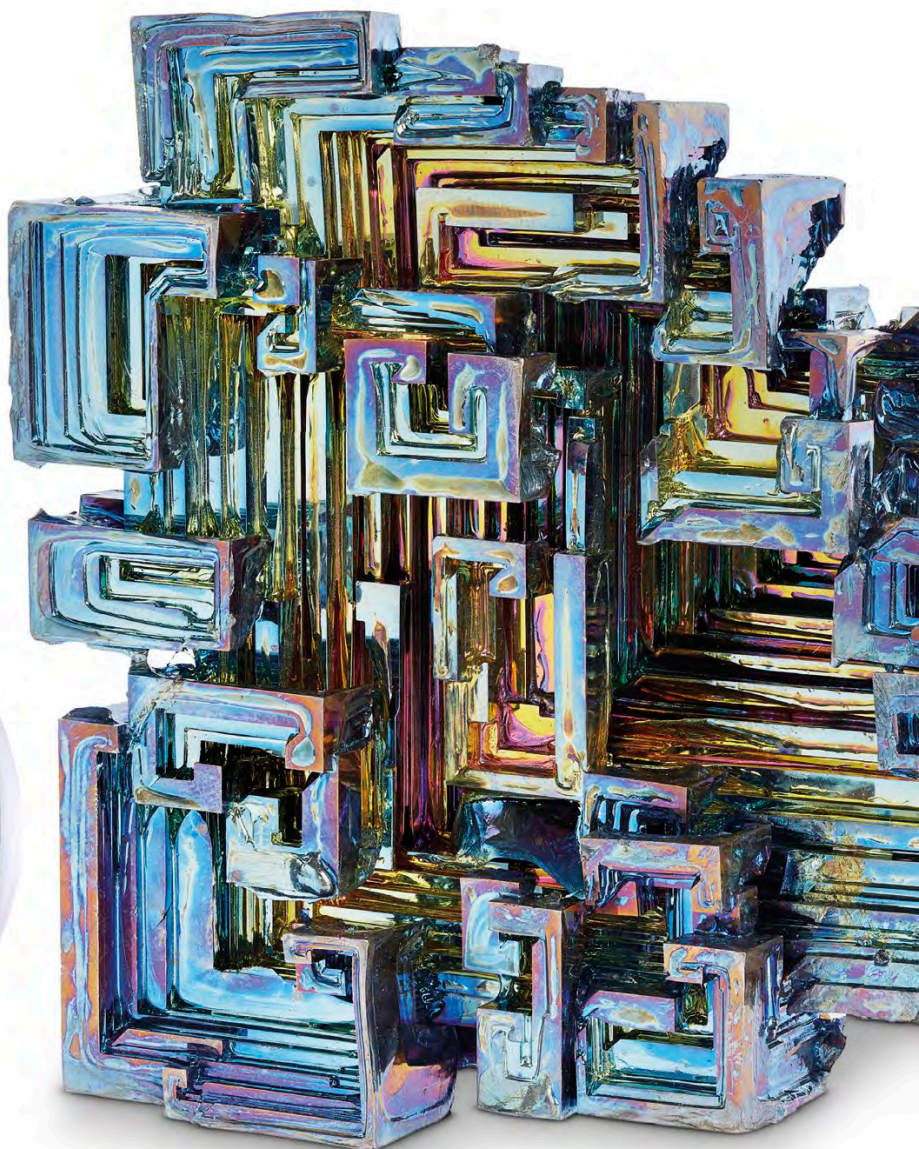
Elements are everywhere: some you can see, like gold, others are almost invisible, like oxygen gas. An element is a substance that cannot be broken up into simpler ingredients. Each one is made up of tiny building blocks called atoms, which are unique for every element. Most elements are joined with other elements to make compounds, which are made by combining two or more elements. This includes water, which is a compound of hydrogen and oxygen.

Elements in our world

There are 118 elements in the periodic table; 92 of them are found in nature, while the others are made by humans. Every element is unique. Most of the elements are solids, like the metals. At room temperature, 11 elements are gases, while bromine and mercury are the only two liquids.



Bromine liquid with bromine gas



Bismuth crystals